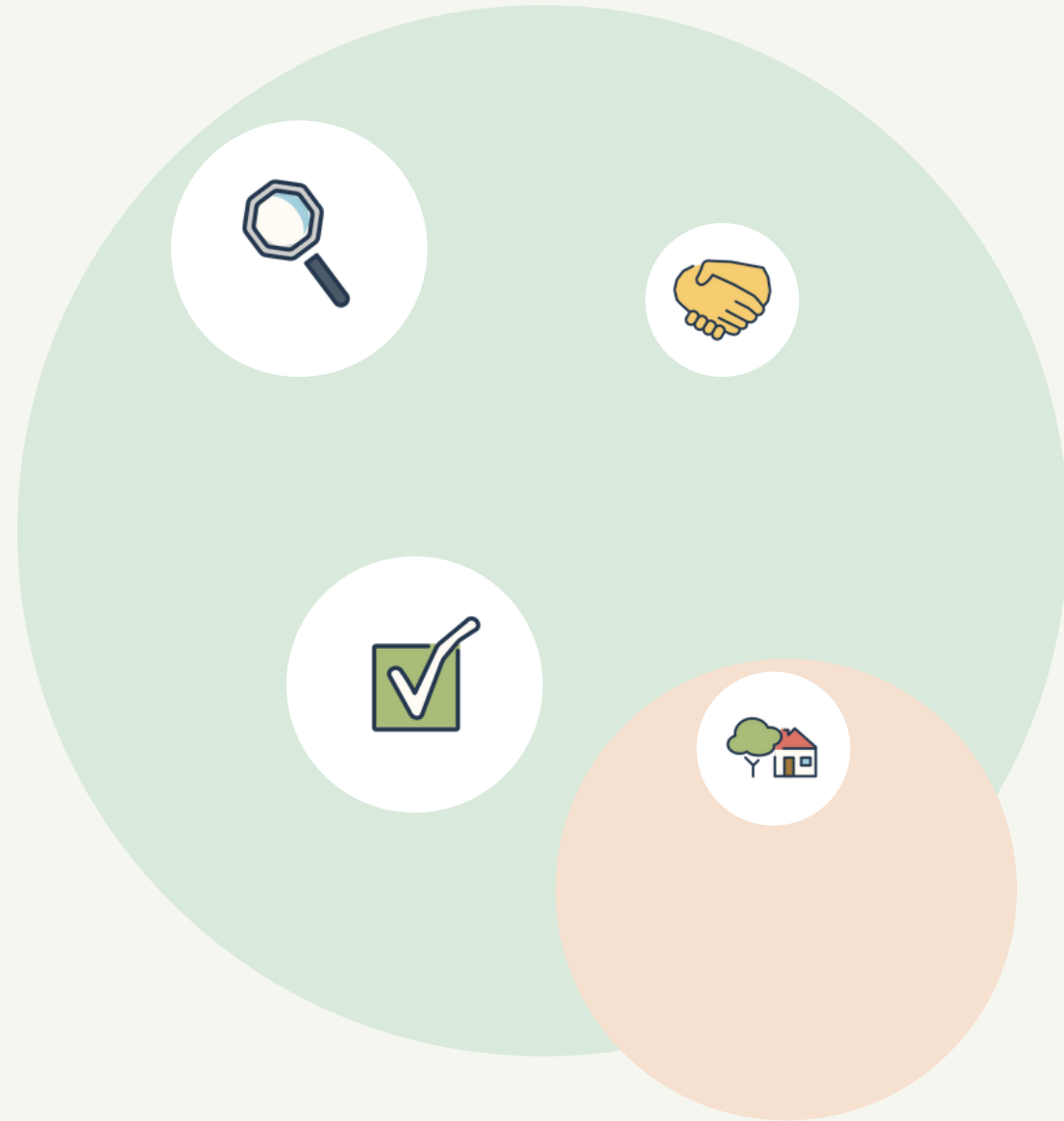


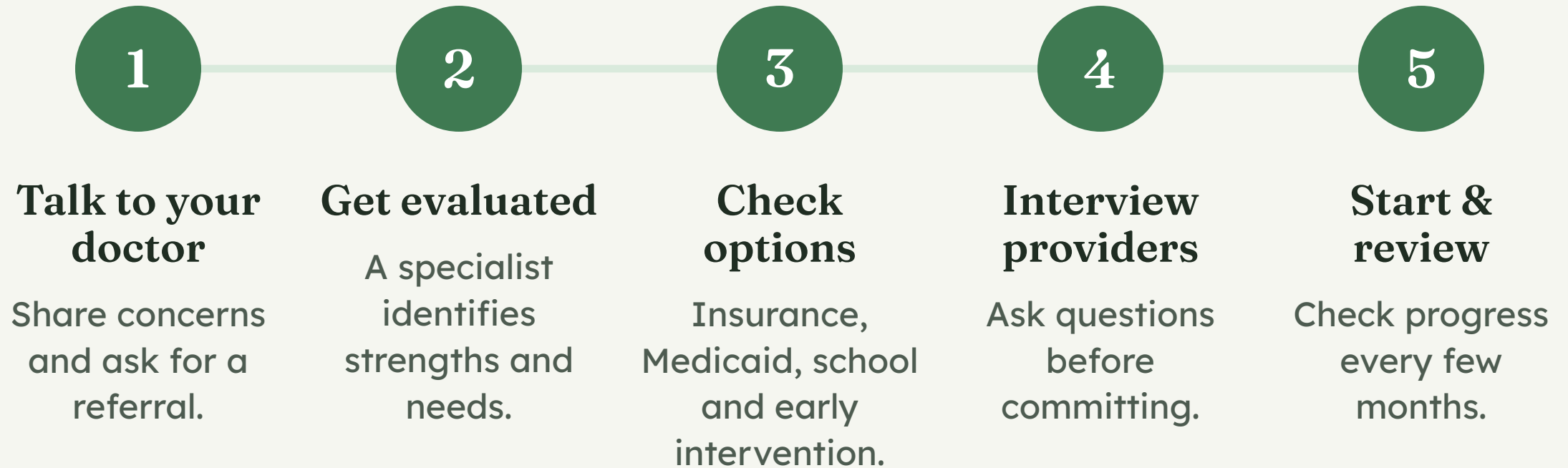
A FAMILY GUIDE

Finding the Right Therapist

Steps, credentials and questions to help you choose support for autism and ADHD.



Your path to services



Free and school-based help

- Birth to 3: Early Intervention services
- Ages 3+: evaluations through your school district
- IEP: special education and related therapies
- 504 plan: accommodations in the classroom



You can ask in writing

Parents can request a free school evaluation at any time. Put the request in writing and keep a copy.

Credentials to look for



OTR/L

Licensed occupational therapist.



CCC-SLP

Certified, licensed
speech-language pathologist.



PhD or PsyD

Licensed psychologist; can
diagnose and provide therapy.



LCSW or LPC

Licensed clinical social worker or
professional counselor.

Questions to ask a provider



How do you set goals?

Listen for goals written with you and your child.



How do you include my child's voice?

Assent, choice and interests should matter.



What does a session look like?

Ask to observe, or watch a short video.



How will we know it's working?

Expect clear measures and regular reviews.

Green flags and red flags



Green flags

- Welcomes questions and observation
- Celebrates strengths and stims
- Adjusts when your child is upset
- Shares progress data openly



Red flags

- Promises a cure or fast fix
- Keeps parents out of sessions
- Pushes on through distress
- Sells costly, unproven treatments



KEY IDEA

You know your child best. A good therapist treats you as a partner.

If it doesn't feel right after a fair try, it's okay to change providers.

Your next steps

- 1 Write down your concerns and your child's strengths.
- 2 Ask your doctor and school about evaluations this week.
- 3 Interview two providers using the questions in this deck.

This overview is educational and does not replace advice from a qualified clinician.